AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS X EXAMINATION 2010

English Compulsory Paper I

Time allowed: 45 minutes Marks 32

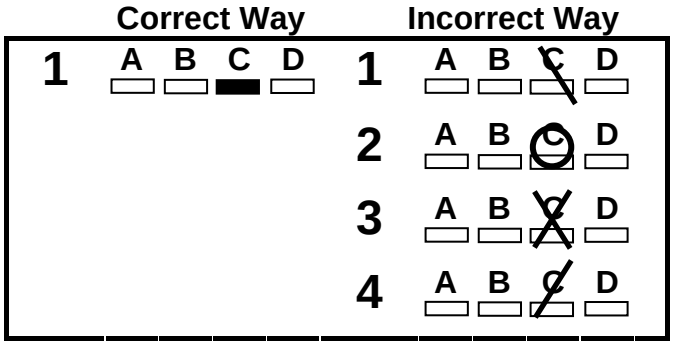
INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read each question carefully.

2. Answer the questions on the separate answer sheet provided. Do NOT write your answers on the question paper.

3. There are 100 answer numbers on the answer sheet. Use answer numbers 1 to 32 only.

4. In each question there are four choices A, B, C, D. Choose ONE. On the answer grid black out the box for your choice with a pencil as shown below.



5. If you want to change your answer, ERASE the first answer completely with a rubber, before blacking out a new box.

6. Do NOT write anything in the answer grid. The computer only records what is in the boxes.

Listening Comprehension Section

This section is 25 minutes long. In this section you will hear two recordings. Each one will be played twice.
Listen carefully to the first recording then read the 8 questions. You will have two minutes' reading time.
The recording will then be replayed. You can make notes on your question paper.

When the recording has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three and a half minutes to pencil in your answers.

Follow the instruction on the front page of paper 1 to show which of the options; A, B, C, or D you have selected for each question.

Listening Passage I
This passage is about the origin of Olympic games along with the relevance of Paralympic games and its history.

Source: www.olympics2012.com

Now listen to the recording.

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

1. The origin of Olympic games goes back to

   A. 770 BC.
   B. 772 BC.
   C. 774 BC.
   D. 776 BC.

2. The games were played in order to

   A. stop conflict.
   B. welcome the winter season.
   C. honour war veterans.
   D. appreciate Greek gods.

3. The first modern Olympic games were held in

   A. Olympia.
   B. Paris.
   C. Athens.
   D. Sweden.

4. The Olympic traditions involve the Olympic rings and

   A. Olympic Creed & Motto.
   B. Olympic Flag.
   C. Olympic Oath.
   D. Olympic Torch.

5. The Paralympic games were planned for

   A. women.
   B. children.
   C. physically disabled persons.
   D. men.

6. The word ‘para’ means

   A. along side.
   B. before.
   C. after.
   D. besides.

7. The Paralympic games are held

   A. 10 days before Olympic games.
   B. 11 days after Olympic games.
   C. 1 month before Olympic games.
   D. 1 month after Olympic games.

8. The first Paralympic games were held in

   A. 1900.
   B. 1924.
   C. 1948.
   D. 1960.

Now, we will play the second recording. It will also be played twice.
Listen carefully to the first playing, then read Questions 9 to 16. You will have two minutes' reading time. The recording will then be replayed.
When the recording has finished, enter your answers on your separate answer sheet. You will have three and a half minutes to pencil in your answers.

Listening Passage II

The passage is about the existence of animals on earth and the interesting information about it.

Source: The Review

Now listen to the recording.

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

9. What type of text is it?

   A. Factual information
   B. Story
   C. Fiction
   D. Biography

10. What is the theme of the passage?

   A. Seasons
   B. Forests
   C. Mountains
   D. Animals

11. Which kind of animal can survive in most land environments?

   A. Polar bears
   B. Wolves
   C. Pandas
   D. Shrimps and Clam

12. Which of the following animals is found only in China?

   A. Pandas
   B. Wolves
   C. Koalas
   D. Beard worms

13. In what conditions, can species of shrimps and clam survive?

   A. Boiling water, ice-cold water
   B. Ice-cold arctic, poisonous gases
   C. Poisonous gases, boiling water
   D. Hot water, rain forests

14. What percentage of Earth's surface do rainforests cover?

   A. 2%
   B. 4%
   C. 6%
   D. 50 %

15. The phrase 'glide through' means to

   A. creep through the air.
   B. run to the coast.
   C. jump in the air.
   D. sail smoothly.

16. According to the writer what are scientists still finding?

   A. The richness of exploring different areas on earth.
   B. New research on ocean animals.
   C. Potential of the findings on rainforests.
   D. Possibilities of studying new species of animals.

Reading Comprehension Section

You have 20 minutes of this session; you are advised to spend approximately 10 minutes on each of the given passages. This section has two reading passages. Each passage is followed by eight multiple choice questions.
Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions which follow:

Passage I

From an early age, I spent most of my free time in the field playing and fighting with the other boys of the village. A boy who remained at home tied to his mother's apron strings was regarded as lazy. At night, I shared my food and blanket with these same boys. I was no more than five when I became a herd-boy looking after sheep and calves in the field. I discovered the almost mystical attachment that the Xhosa have for cattle, not only as a source of food and wealth, but as a blessing from God and a source of happiness. It was in the fields that I learned how to knock birds out of the sky with a slingshot, to gather wild honey and fruits and edible roots, to drink warm, sweet milk straight from the udder of a cow, to swim in the clear, cold streams, and to catch fish with twine and sharpened bits of wire. I learned to stick-fight – essential knowledge to any rural African boy – and became adept at its various techniques, evading blows, moving in one direction and striking in another, breaking away from an opponent with quick footwork. From these days I date my love of the field, of open spaces, the simple beauties of nature, and the clean line of the horizon.

As boys, we were mostly left to our own devices. We played with toys we made ourselves. We moulded animals and birds out of clay. We made ox-drawn sledges out of tree branches. Nature was our playground. The hills above Qunu were dotted with large smooth rocks which we transformed into our own roller-coaster. We sat on flat stones and slid down the face of the large rocks. We did this until our backsides were so sore we could hardly sit down. I learned to ride by sitting atop weaned calves – after being thrown to the ground several times; one got the hang of it.

I learned my lesson one day from an unruly donkey. We had been taking turns climbing up and down its back and when my chance came I jumped on and the donkey bolted into a nearby thorn bush. It bent its head, trying to unseat me, which it did, but not before the thorns had pricked and scratched my face, embarrassing me in front of my friends. Like the people of the East, Africans have a highly developed sense of dignity, or what the Chinese call 'face.' I had lost face among my friends.

Source: Extract from Nelson Mandela autobiography, Long Walk to Freedom

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

17. What almost mystical connection did the writer discover as a herd-boy?

A. Happiness and God's blessings
B. Food and health
C. Games and honour
D. Nature and life

18. Which emotion can be inferred when they had injured their backs while sliding down the rocks?

A. Happiness
B. Excitement
C. Enthusiasm
D. Pain

19. In your opinion, why did the author say that he had lost face among his friends?

A. He used a Chinese expression.
B. He was embarrassed.
C. His face was injured.
D. He had lost out to a donkey.

20. What objects were made by the author as a boy?

A. Toys and cows
B. Animals and ox-drawn sledges
C. Huts and school
D. Chair and table

21. By saying "nature was our playground" the writer means that

A. there was no playground.
B. they made all outdoors a playground.
C. nature was the source of creation.
D. nature was the source of knowledge.

22. The word 'techniques' (line 11) means

A. learning games of rural boys.
B. making different shapes.
C. ways of doing things.
D. learning many skills.

23. The instrument 'slingshot' is used for

A. digging the ground.
B. cutting vegetables.
C. hunting birds.
D. ploughing fields.

24. The character of the writer in the passage proves to be

A. naughty and active.
B. shy and poor.
C. self-made and dignified.
D. lazy and happy-go-lucky.

Read the passage carefully and then answer the multiple choice questions which follow:

Passage II

Eddie was a carpet-fitter, and he hated it. For ten years he had spent his days sitting, squatting, kneeling or crawling on floors, in houses, offices, shops, factories and restaurants. Ten years of his life, cutting and fitting carpets for other people to walk on, without even seeing them. When his work was done, no-one ever appreciated it. No- one ever said "Oh, that's a beautiful job, the carpet fits so neatly." They just walked all over it. Eddie was sick of it.

He was especially sick of it on this hot, humid day in August, as he worked to put the finishing touches to today's job. He was just cutting and fixing the last edge on a huge red carpet which he had fitted in the living room of Mrs. Smith's house. Rich Mrs. Smith, who changed her carpets every year and always bought the best. Rich Mrs. Smith, who had never even given him a cup of tea all day, and who made him go outside when he wanted to smoke. Ah well, it was four o'clock and he had nearly finished. At least he would be able to get home early today. He began to day-dream about the weekend, about the Saturday football game he always played for the local team, where he was known as "Ed the Head" for his skill in heading goals from corner kicks.

Eddie sat back and sighed. The job was done, and it was time for a last cigarette. He began tapping the pockets of his overalls, looking for the new packet of Marlboro he had bought that morning. They were not there.

It was as he swung around to look in his toolbox for the cigarettes that Eddie saw the lump. Right in the middle of the brand new bright red carpet, there was a lump. A very visible lump. A lump the size of -- the size of a packet of cigarettes.

"Blast!" said Eddie angrily. "I've done it again! I've left the cigarettes under the blasted carpet!"

He had done this once before, and taking up and refitting the carpet had taken him two hours. Eddie was determined that he was not going to spend another two hours in this house. He decided to get rid of the lump another way. It would mean wasting a good packet of cigarettes, nearly full, but anything was better than taking up the whole carpet and fitting it again. He turned to his toolbox for a large hammer.

Holding the hammer, Eddie approached the lump in the carpet. He didn't want to damage the carpet itself, so he took a block of wood and placed it on top of the lump. Then he began to beat the block of wood as hard as he could. He kept beating, hoping Mrs. Smith wouldn't hear the noise and come to see what he was doing. It would be difficult to explain why he was hammering the middle of her beautiful new carpet.

After three or four minutes, the lump was beginning to flatten out. Eddie imagined the cigarette box breaking up, and the crushed cigarettes spreading out under the carpet. Soon, he judged that the lump was almost invisible. Clearing up his tools, he began to move the furniture back into the living room, and he was careful to place one of the coffee tables over the place where the lump had been, just to make sure that no-one would see the spot where his cigarettes had been lost. Finally, the job was finished, and he called Mrs. Smith from the dining room to inspect his work.

"Yes, dear, very nice," said the lady, peering around the room briefly. "You'll be sending me a bill, then?"

"Yes madam, as soon as I report to the office tomorrow that the job is done." Eddie picked up his tools, and began to walk out to the van. Mrs. Smith accompanied him. She seemed a little worried about something.

"Young man," she began, as he climbed into the cab of his van, laying his toolbox on the passenger seat beside him, "while you were working today, you didn't by any chance see any sign of Armand, did you? Armand is my parrot. A beautiful bird, just beautiful, such colours in his feathers... I let him out of his cage, you see, this morning, and he's disappeared. He likes to walk around the house, and he's so good, he usually just comes back to his cage after an hour or so and gets right in. Only today he didn't come back. He's never done such a thing before, it's most peculiar..."

"No, madam, I haven't seen him anywhere," said Eddie, as he reached to start the van

And saw his packet of Marlboro cigarettes on the dashboard, where he had left it at lunchtime and remembered the lump in the carpet, realized what the lump was, remembered the hammering and began to feel rather sick.

Source: www.pearsonlongman.com

Mark your responses to these questions on your multiple choice answer sheet.

25. Why did Eddie hate being a carpet-fitter?

A. The pay was too low.
B. He didn't like working alone.
C. No one appreciated his work
D. He couldn't smoke on the job.

26. What did Eddie think of Mrs. Smith?

A. She was a kind, thoughtful lady.
B. She was rich and selfish.
C. She was always losing things.
D. She had good taste in furniture.

27. Why was Eddie called "Ed the Head" by his friends?

A. Because he was such an intelligent carpet-fitter.
B. Because he had a large head.
C. Because he was very proud and self-important.
D. Because of his football skills.

28. What did Eddie want to do when he had finished fitting the carpet?

A. Have a cigarette
B. Hammer the carpet flat
C. Look for Mrs. Smith's lost bird
D. Start work in the dining room

29. Why didn't Eddie remove the carpet to take out the thing that was causing the lump?

A. He couldn't take the carpet up once he had fitted it.
B. He didn't need the cigarettes because he had some more in the van.
C. It would take too long to remove the carpet and re-fit it.
D. He intended to come back and remove the lump the next day.

30. What was Mrs. Smith worried about?

A. Her bird was missing.
B. She thought the carpet was going to be too expensive.
C. She thought Eddie had been smoking in the house.
D. She couldn't find her husband Armand.

31. "Eddie was determined...." means that he

A. had no idea.
B. decided for sure.
C. felt very angry.
D. couldn't decide.

32. "He's never done such a thing before, it's most peculiar..." The word ‘peculiar’ means

A. normal.
B. like a bird.
C. difficult.
D. strange.

END OF PAPER

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